Alder

Atlanta / Restaurant build-out

A dining room that feels settled from the first service. A kitchen planned for the pace behind it.

Our starting point is the meeting of those two ambitions: protect the room’s character while resolving equipment, building services, and the sequence of work early.

FIRST CONDITION

Before we establish an opening date, we recommend confirming the existing utilities and the kitchen exhaust route.

Working construction budget

$1.50m, including $150k owner contingency

Illustrative sequence

24 weeks from preconstruction authorization; opening date unconfirmed

Status

Illustrative proposal / Not an estimate

Prepared by

Author to be confirmed

01 / PROJECT & APPROACH

Do you understand what we are trying to make?

A room that works as well as it feels.

Alder is imagined as a neighborhood restaurant with the kitchen in view and the dining room at ease. We would begin where those experiences meet: equipment layout, service routes, sound, and the junctions between materials.

Area
3,200 sq ft

Seats
80

Premises
Leased second-generation restaurant space

Kitchen
Open to view from the dining room

Service
Evening dinner program

All project facts are illustrative inputs for this study.

THREE PRIORITIES

01 **Protect the character of the room.**
Finishes, light, and sound are decided as a whole, and the junctions guests see are resolved before they are built.

02 **Resolve the working requirements of the kitchen.**
Equipment, utilities, ventilation, and service routes are coordinated before pricing, not after installation begins.

03 **Make cost and sequence legible before committing to the build.**
Every amount carries its basis and every date its starting condition, so authorization is an informed step.

THE TWO LARGEST UNKNOWNS

C-01 **Existing utility capacity**
Electrical, gas, and water capacity for an expanded kitchen has not been verified.

C-02 **Kitchen exhaust route**
A compliant path from hood to roof or façade has not been confirmed with the landlord.

BASIS OF THIS INTERPRETATION

Client inputs
Illustrative brief / 14 Oct 2026

Drawings
None received

Site observation

None / no visit made

Status

Fictional scenario

Basis of this proposal →

HOW WE WOULD WORK

We build with attention to the whole project and the details that carry it. Our role is to make the design buildable, coordinate the work, and keep decisions clear from the first review through turnover.

PROPOSED STATEMENT / FOR COMPANY APPROVAL

Review constructability with the architect

Reconcile trade scope against the drawings

Coordinate procurement and site work

Prepare inspections and handover

BASIS OF THIS PROPOSAL / 01 PROJECT & APPROACH

Basis of this proposal

- Fictional scenario; no site survey or client drawings received.

CATEGORY	Client inputs
ITEM	Founder brief: 80 seats, visible kitchen, evening service
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Illustrative

CATEGORY	Client inputs
ITEM	Premises: 3,200 sq ft leased second-generation space
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Illustrative

CATEGORY	Drawings
ITEM	Architect’s drawing set
DATED	—
STATUS	Not received

CATEGORY	Drawings
ITEM	Existing building and MEP drawings from landlord
DATED	—
STATUS	Not received

CATEGORY	Drawings
ITEM	Kitchen equipment schedule and cut sheets
DATED	—
STATUS	Not received

CATEGORY	Site observations
ITEM	Walk-through of the premises
DATED	—
STATUS	Not made

CATEGORY	Site observations
ITEM	Existing services and exhaust route survey
DATED	—
STATUS	Proposed / D-02

CATEGORY	Assumptions
ITEM	No structural expansion of the premises
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Assumed

CATEGORY	Assumptions
ITEM	Existing services reused where capacity permits
DATED	14 Oct 2026
STATUS	Unverified

CATEGORY	Outstanding
ITEM	Lease exhibit and landlord work letter
DATED	—
STATUS	Requested on appointment

CATEGORY	Outstanding
ITEM	Hazardous-material survey, if the landlord holds one
DATED	—
STATUS	Requested on appointment

02 / RELEVANT WORK

What have you actually done that matters here?

Evidence before anecdote.

This reference will focus on the work Freeman can document: the assignment, the people involved, and the decisions made in the field.

For Alder, the question is how that experience informs the coordination of a guest-facing room and a working kitchen.

■ Not ready for client issue. Each historical field below must be filled from a record, or the topic removed.

Verification register →

REFERENCE / FREEMAN ROLE PENDING VERIFICATION

Little Rey / Rocket Farm Restaurants

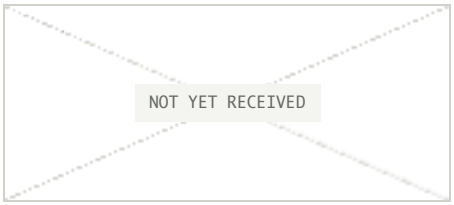


PLATE 2.1 / FINISHED WORK

Finished photograph of the junction in use

PLATE 2.2 / FIELD RECORD

Approved detail or field photograph of the same junction

1 Intent

☐ TO VERIFY

Not yet documented. Record needed: the design requirement for a guest-facing junction, from the architect’s drawings.

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2 Condition

☐ TO VERIFY

Not yet documented. Record needed: what the team encountered, with a dated field report or RFI.

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3 Freeman’s contribution

☐ TO VERIFY

Not yet documented. Record needed: the action Freeman or a named team member took, credited separately from the architect and other builders.

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4 Evidence

☐ TO VERIFY

Not yet received. An attributable photograph or approved detail, with photographer, date, and permission.

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5 Relevance to Alder

PROPOSED ACTION

Before ordering millwork, we would mock up the junction where the dining room's finishes meet the open kitchen's cleanable surfaces and review it with the architect.

A-01 Millwork allowance S-02 Architectural build-out M-05 W5 / long-lead release

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RELEVANT WORK / EQUIPMENT COORDINATION

PLATE 2.1 / FINISHED WORK

Finished photograph of the kitchen line

PLATE 2.2 / FIELD RECORD

Equipment layout or utility rough-in record

Equipment coordination

1 Intent

TO VERIFY

Not yet documented. Record needed: the operational requirement for the kitchen equipment and its utilities.

2 Condition

TO VERIFY

Not yet documented. Record needed: a dated coordination record — for example a rough-in conflict or a revised equipment schedule.

3 Freeman's contribution

TO VERIFY

Not yet documented. Record needed: Freeman's exact coordination role, distinguished from the equipment supplier's and the architect's.

4 Evidence

TO VERIFY

Not yet received. A field record or approved drawing detail with permission to show it.

5 Relevance to Alder

PROPOSED ACTION

For Alder, we would confirm who purchases, installs, and starts each piece of equipment, then overlay the equipment schedule on the utility rough-in before pricing.

D-01 Decision: equipment boundary S-07 Kitchen equipment boundary M-21 W21 / equipment readiness

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RELEVANT WORK / A FIELD DECISION

PLATE 2.1 / FINISHED WORK
Photograph of the completed condition

PLATE 2.2 / FIELD RECORD
Field record of the decision, dated

A field decision

1 Intent
☐ TO VERIFY
Not yet documented. Record needed: what the drawings required at the point the decision was made.

2 Condition
☐ TO VERIFY
Not yet documented. Record needed: the concealed or unexpected condition, with a dated field record.

3 Freeman’s contribution
☐ TO VERIFY
Not yet documented. Record needed: who proposed the response, who approved it, and how cost and time were reported.

4 Evidence
☐ TO VERIFY
Not yet received. A field photograph or written record, attributed and permitted.

5 Relevance to Alder
■ PROPOSED ACTION
For Alder, we would investigate the existing services and the exhaust route before the construction baseline, so that a concealed condition becomes a planned decision rather than a field surprise.

D-02 Decision: services investigation C-02 Exhaust route condition M-08 W8 / construction start gate

VERIFICATION REGISTER / 02 RELEVANT WORK

Verification register

Little Rey / Rocket Farm Restaurants. Every field must be resolved from a record before this reference is issued to a client. If only one contribution can be substantiated, one account is published. If none can, the reference is withdrawn.

BEFORE CLIENT ISSUE

Location
Piedmont or Northside Parkway — unresolved

Dates
Not established

Contracting entity
Not established

Direct client
Not established

Freeman or prior-employer work

Not established

Contracted scope

Not established

Named participants

Not established

Drawing and image permissions

Not requested

Claimed outcome

None claimed

If the work was an individual's prior experience, it is labeled "Team experience / completed while at [company]", not presented as a Freeman commission. No Rocket Farm endorsement is implied.

PUBLICLY CONFIRMED CONTEXT

Rocket Farm Restaurants lists Little Rey among its restaurants↗

www.rocketfarmrestaurants.com/

Little Rey / Piedmont↗

www.littlerey.com/piedmont

Little Rey / Northside Parkway↗

www.littlerey.com/northside-parkway

These public sources identify the restaurant and its two Atlanta locations. They do not establish Freeman's construction role.

EDITORIAL TEMPLATE, NOT APPROVED COPY

At [location], [legal entity or named team member] was responsible for [documented scope] during [dates]. The record below shows [specific action].

03 / PEOPLE & SCOPE

Who will do what, and who carries the gaps?

A clear line from the decision to the work.

The project manager would be your primary contact. The superintendent would coordinate the daily work. Design changes would return to the architect; cost and time effects would return to you before authorization.

No biographies or photographs are shown until each person's participation and availability are confirmed.

PROPOSED TEAM

Freeman principal

RESPONSIBILITY Client relationship, escalation, commercial oversight

STATUS Person to confirm

Project manager

PRIMARY CONTACT

RESPONSIBILITY Trade scope, procurement, cost reporting, decisions

STATUS Person to confirm

Superintendent

RESPONSIBILITY Daily coordination, sequencing, quality, site safety

STATUS Person to confirm

Architect / owner-appointed

RESPONSIBILITY Design intent, coordinated documents, design responses

STATUS Appointment to confirm

Founder / owner

RESPONSIBILITY Brief, selections, owner purchases, authorizations

STATUS Fictional role

Roles are shown until named people are confirmed for participation and availability.

DELIVERY APPROACH

1

Verify existing conditions

2

Reconcile drawings and trade proposals

3

Coordinate procurement and construction

4

Test inspect, and turn over

PROPOSED SCOPE

S-01	Selective demolition
S-02	Architectural build-out

S-03	Mechanical, electrical, plumbing, and fire-protection work, coordinated
S-04	Installation coordination for owner-supplied items
S-05	Inspections and turnover

All proposed scope, pending survey and documents.

WHERE RESPONSIBILITIES MEET

Kitchen equipment. Owner purchases; supplier installs and starts; Freeman coordinates access and priced utility connections. Exact limits confirmed before pricing.

Responsibility boundaries →

RESPONSIBILITY BOUNDARIES / 03 PEOPLE & SCOPE

Responsibility boundaries

- Illustrative allocations to test the format. These are not standard Freeman contractual terms; every limit is confirmed before pricing.

S-07 Kitchen equipment

WORKED EXAMPLE

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Coordinates delivery, access, and set-in sequence; provides priced utility connections to agreed points
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner purchases; equipment supplier installs and starts up
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Exact connection points for each item; who provides final hook-up and startup testing D-01 Decision

S-08 Exhaust hood and duct

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Duct route, roof or façade penetration, fire-rated enclosure
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Hood supplied with equipment package
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Whether the hood is in the owner’s package; landlord approval of the route D-02 Decision

S-09 Walk-in cooler

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Slab preparation, power, and drain
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Supplier provides box and refrigeration
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Remote condenser location D-01 Decision

S-10 Low-voltage, POS, audio

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Conduit, back boxes, and pull strings
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner’s vendors cable, install, and program
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Device locations not yet set

S-11 Loose furniture

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Receipt and placement if requested
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner purchases and installs
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Banquette: built-in millwork or loose furniture A-01 Allowance

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S-12 Permits and utility fees

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Building permit application and inspection coordination
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Owner pays statutory permit and utility connection charges
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Health department plan review submission

S-13 Landlord work

INCLUDED / FREEMAN	Coordination with landlord’s contractors
OWNER OR OTHER PARTY	Landlord work letter items
UNRESOLVED BOUNDARY	Work letter not received

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04 / SCHEDULE

What has to happen before we can open?

24 illustrative weeks from authorization to handover.

> Opening follows owner training, operational readiness, and required approvals. No opening date is committed.

The opening depends on decisions made before the site gets busy. We would establish the construction start after the permit, site access, and coordinated documents are ready. Equipment selections and release dates would be tracked against the work they enable.

Illustrative sequencing assumptions, not permitting or procurement predictions. A delay at the start gate requires a revised schedule; downstream dates are not assumed to hold.

Gray: proposed activity / ◇ decision gate / orange: selected gate and dependent work

Existing conditions and preconstruction — 1–4

Weeks 1–4 / runs alongside design coordination and permitting
Utilities, exhaust route, brief confirmed



Design coordination and permitting — 3–8

Weeks 3–8 / runs alongside existing conditions and preconstruction; long-lead procurement
Design and permit readiness before site work



Long-lead procurement — 5–16

Weeks 5–16 / runs alongside design coordination and permitting; demolition and rough-in; finishes and equipment coordination
Approved selections and release authority



Demolition and rough-in — 9–14

Weeks 9–14 / runs alongside long-lead procurement
Permit, possession, coordinated documents



Finishes and equipment coordination — 15–21

Weeks 15–21 / runs alongside long-lead procurement
Rough-in approvals and equipment arrivals



Testing, inspections, punch, handover — 22–24

Weeks 22–24 / no overlap
Systems ready; inspections available



M-08

Week 8 / Construction start gate

A DELAY AT THIS GATE REQUIRES A REVISED SCHEDULE

PREREQUISITE

Building permit issued, possession of the premises, coordinated documents

RESPONSIBLE

Project manager, with architect

WORKSTREAMS

Design coordination and permitting; Demolition and rough-in

AFFECTS

C-01 Utility capacity

C-02 Exhaust route

B-01 Trade construction

ACTIVE CONDITIONS / ALWAYS OPEN UNTIL RESOLVED

C-01 Utility capacity unverified

ACCOUNTABLE Project manager
NEXT Survey electrical, gas, and water service against the equipment load

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C-02 Exhaust route unconfirmed

ACCOUNTABLE Architect, with project manager
NEXT Trace a compliant hood-to-roof route; seek landlord approval

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C-03 Equipment lead times unquoted

ACCOUNTABLE Founder’s equipment supplier
NEXT Written lead times once selections are approved

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05 / BUDGET

What does this include, how certain is it, and what else must we fund?

A clear basis for the next conversation.

This is a planning exercise. Kitchen equipment, loose furniture, professional fees, and pre-opening operating costs are outside this total. The full development budget remains to be established.

ASSUMPTIONS

- Second-generation restaurant space
- No structural expansion assumed
- Existing capacity and concealed conditions unverified

■ All figures are invented to test information design. They are not market guidance, a Freeman estimate, or a quotation. Amounts are rounded.

CONSTRUCTION PLANNING TOTAL

$1,500,000

Includes a $150,000 owner-held contingency. Illustrative; not priced against drawings, a site survey, or trade proposals.

COMPONENT / PRICING STATUS	ILLUSTRATIVE
Trade construction excluding allowances Planning placeholder; unquoted	$1,000,000
Finish and fixture allowances Included once; selections unresolved	$150,000
Millwork →	$80,000
Decorative lighting →	$40,000
Finish selections →	$30,000
General conditions, fee, insurance Combined placeholder; split in detailed estimate	$200,000
Proposed construction subtotal Not a contract sum	$1,350,000
Owner-held construction contingency Separate reserve; not contractor revenue	$150,000
Construction planning total Includes owner contingency	$1,500,000

Allowances are excluded from the $1,000,000 trade line to prevent double counting. Each is an illustrative installed package; labor, freight, taxes, and markups are reconciled in the issued estimate.

ISSUED ESTIMATE WILL STATE

Drawing revision / Pricing date / Validity period / Tax treatment / Fee basis / Treatment of changes — not established in this study

OUTSIDE THIS TOTAL

- Owner-purchased kitchen equipment and furniture
- Architect and consultant fees
- Statutory permit and utility connection charges
- Leasing, financing, and pre-opening expenses
- Hazardous-material remediation and major off-site works

Construction coordination of excluded items can still be included: the purchase is excluded; utility connections and installation coordination may be priced (S-07).

NEXT PRICING ACTION

Price a detailed estimate against the architect's drawings once D-01 and D-02 are resolved.

D-01 Equipment boundary D-02 Services investigation

MILLWORK ALLOWANCE / 05 BUDGET

A-01 ALLOWANCE / WITHIN B-02 FINISH AND FIXTURE ALLOWANCES

Millwork allowance

$80,000

Illustrative installed package / included once in the $1,500,000 planning total

INCLUSIONS

- Bar die and back bar
- Host stand
- Banquette bases, if built in
- Open-kitchen counter front

BASIS

Illustrative installed package for an 80-seat room. No drawings, shop drawings, or fabricator quotation.

Unresolved selection

Bar length and top material; whether the banquette is millwork or loose furniture (S-11).

Responsible

Founder selects, with architect; project manager prices

Decision date

Selections approved before W5 long-lead release

M-04 W4 / Brief and basis agreed

Potential effect

Not yet priced

No cost change is shown until a selection is priced against a quotation.

OTHER ALLOWANCES

Decorative lighting / Finish selections

DECORATIVE LIGHTING ALLOWANCE / 05 BUDGET

A-02 ALLOWANCE / WITHIN B-02 FINISH AND FIXTURE ALLOWANCES

Decorative lighting allowance

$40,000

Illustrative installed package / included once in the $1,500,000 planning total

INCLUSIONS

- Pendants over the bar and banquette
- Wall sconces
- Dimming for decorative circuits

BASIS

Illustrative fixture-and-install package. Fixture selections and quantities not received.

Unresolved selection

Fixture selections, counts, and lead times; dimming control approach.

Responsible

Founder selects, with architect or lighting designer

Decision date

Selections approved before W5 long-lead release

M-04 W4 / Brief and basis agreed

Potential effect

Not yet priced

No cost change is shown until a selection is priced against a quotation.

OTHER ALLOWANCES

Millwork / Finish selections

FINISH SELECTIONS ALLOWANCE / 05 BUDGET

A-03 ALLOWANCE / WITHIN B-02 FINISH AND FIXTURE ALLOWANCES

Finish selections allowance

$30,000

Illustrative installed package / included once in the $1,500,000 planning total

INCLUSIONS

- Feature tile at the open-kitchen wall
- Dining room wall finish
- Flooring transition at the kitchen threshold

BASIS

Illustrative premium over base finishes carried in the trade line.

Unresolved selection

Tile, wall, and floor selections; cleanability at the kitchen threshold.

Responsible

Founder selects, with architect

Decision date

Selections approved before W14 rough-in review

M-14 W14 / Rough-in review

Potential effect

Not yet priced

No cost change is shown until a selection is priced against a quotation.

OTHER ALLOWANCES

Millwork / Decorative lighting

06 / DECISIONS

What are we deciding now, and what will Freeman do next?

The next step is a working session.

We propose reviewing the kitchen responsibility boundary, the existing building services, and a defined preconstruction scope. Freeman would return with a written scope, fee, and deliverable schedule for review.

Construction authorization would follow a separate agreement. Reading or acknowledging this proposal does not authorize work.

D-01

Confirm kitchen equipment purchasing and installation boundary

S-07 Responsibility boundary A-01 Millwork allowance M-21 W21 / equipment readiness

ACCOUNTABLE	Founder, with PM recommendation
NEEDED BY	Before scope pricing
STATE / CONSEQUENCE	Open / Prevents omissions and double pricing

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D-02

Authorize existing-services and exhaust investigation

C-01 Utility capacity C-02 Exhaust route M-08 W8 / start gate

ACCOUNTABLE	Founder, with architect’s input
NEEDED BY	Before construction baseline
STATE / CONSEQUENCE	Open / Tests schedule and cost assumptions

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D-03

Confirm preconstruction deliverables and fee

B-03 General conditions and fee M-04 W4 / basis agreed

ACCOUNTABLE	Founder, with Freeman principal
NEEDED BY	Before services begin
STATE / CONSEQUENCE	Open / Establishes the next engagement

Request a working session →

Opens a draft in your email application. Nothing is sent until you send it. To: gabe@freemangc.com

Download this issue ↓

Printable record of Issue 01, 14 October 2026, with every disclosure and caption.

Prepared by Author to be confirmed / Issue 01 / 14 October 2026

Illustrative proposal / Not an estimate. All names, figures, and dates are illustrative inputs to a design study and are not a Freeman offer. All figures are invented to test information design. They are not market guidance, a Freeman estimate, or a quotation. Amounts are rounded.

Built for generations
